# Know Your Local Hazards

Research the hazards that could affect the places you use, record the official instruction for each one, and recheck it regularly.

**! WARNING — URGENT ACTION**

**During an emergency, current instructions from local authorities take priority over this worksheet.** General preparedness guidance helps you plan; it does not set local evacuation zones, routes, shelter locations, alert thresholds, or re-entry rules.

## 1. LIST THE PLACES TO CHECK

| Place | Address or route | People, animals, access, or transport needs |
|---|---|---|
| Home | | |
| Workplace(s) | | |
| School / care site | | |
| Common travel routes | | |

## 2. ASK OFFICIAL SOURCES

- ☐ **Local emergency management:** ask which hazards affect each place, who can order evacuation or sheltering, and where official zone and route information is published.
- ☐ **Official alerting services:** enroll every household member who can receive alerts; note coverage, languages, accessibility features, and a backup method. Wireless Emergency Alerts require no sign-up, but local opt-in systems may.
- ☐ **Map owners:** check official evacuation-zone maps and, where applicable, flood, fire, earthquake, tsunami, dam, landslide, severe-weather, or other hazard maps. Record the map issuer, layer, and date—not only a screenshot.
- ☐ **Workplaces, schools, and care sites:** request their emergency, reunification, closure, and transportation procedures.
- ☐ **Utility providers:** ask about hazard-specific shutoffs, outage alerts, safe service interruption, medical-equipment programs, and restoration information.
- ☐ **Insurance and property records:** review declarations, exclusions, deductibles, inventories, surveys, disclosures, permits, and assessor or recorder documents. Ask the insurer or record holder to explain unclear entries.

**Map caution:** a map may describe one hazard or planning purpose only. Do not treat an insurance, parcel, or risk map as an evacuation order. Confirm its purpose with the issuing authority.

# Know Your Local Hazards — continued

Use one record for every hazard at every place it affects. Duplicate these pages when needed.

## HAZARD RECORD A

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Hazard** | | **Places affected** | ☐ Home ☐ Work ☐ School/care ☐ Routes |
| **Warning signs I may observe** | | | |
| **Official alert source** | Agency, service/channel, sign-up or access method: | | |
| **Protective action** | What the issuing authority says to do: | | |
| **Evacuate or shelter trigger** | Exact official term, level, zone, boundary, or condition—and who issues it: | | |
| **Seasonal timing** | Likely period, lead time, and conditions (or “year-round”): | | |
| **Household-specific complications** | Mobility, medical/power, communication, transport, children, animals, language, or route limits: | | |
| **Information verified** | Date: _____ | **Verified with** | Agency/record and URL, office, or document ID: _____ |

# Know Your Local Hazards — continued

## HAZARD RECORD B

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Hazard** | | **Places affected** | ☐ Home ☐ Work ☐ School/care ☐ Routes |
| **Warning signs I may observe** | | | |
| **Official alert source** | Agency, service/channel, sign-up or access method: | | |
| **Protective action** | What the issuing authority says to do: | | |
| **Evacuate or shelter trigger** | Exact official term, level, zone, boundary, or condition—and who issues it: | | |
| **Seasonal timing** | Likely period, lead time, and conditions (or “year-round”): | | |
| **Household-specific complications** | Mobility, medical/power, communication, transport, children, animals, language, or route limits: | | |
| **Information verified** | Date: _____ | **Verified with** | Agency/record and URL, office, or document ID: _____ |

# Know Your Local Hazards — continued

Record what an official source says, not what a neighbor, social post, or unlabeled map assumes.

## HAZARD RECORD C

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Hazard** | | **Places affected** | ☐ Home ☐ Work ☐ School/care ☐ Routes |
| **Warning signs I may observe** | | | |
| **Official alert source** | Agency, service/channel, sign-up or access method: | | |
| **Protective action** | What the issuing authority says to do: | | |
| **Evacuate or shelter trigger** | Exact official term, level, zone, boundary, or condition—and who issues it: | | |
| **Seasonal timing** | Likely period, lead time, and conditions (or “year-round”): | | |
| **Household-specific complications** | Mobility, medical/power, communication, transport, children, animals, language, or route limits: | | |
| **Information verified** | Date: _____ | **Verified with** | Agency/record and URL, office, or document ID: _____ |

# Know Your Local Hazards — continued

## HAZARD RECORD D

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Hazard** | | **Places affected** | ☐ Home ☐ Work ☐ School/care ☐ Routes |
| **Warning signs I may observe** | | | |
| **Official alert source** | Agency, service/channel, sign-up or access method: | | |
| **Protective action** | What the issuing authority says to do: | | |
| **Evacuate or shelter trigger** | Exact official term, level, zone, boundary, or condition—and who issues it: | | |
| **Seasonal timing** | Likely period, lead time, and conditions (or “year-round”): | | |
| **Household-specific complications** | Mobility, medical/power, communication, transport, children, animals, language, or route limits: | | |
| **Information verified** | Date: _____ | **Verified with** | Agency/record and URL, office, or document ID: _____ |

# Know Your Local Hazards — continued

Finish the local blanks, compare hazards across places, and carry the results into your plans.

## LOCAL DETAILS STILL TO RESOLVE

◎ LOCAL INFORMATION — VERIFY BEFORE APPROVAL

**[VERIFY] Local emergency-management authority: _____**

**[VERIFY] Official local alert service and enrollment page/number: _____**

**[VERIFY] Evacuation-zone map issuer, URL/office, and my zone(s): _____**

**[VERIFY] Locally applicable flood/fire/earthquake or other map(s): _____**

**[VERIFY] Utility emergency/outage sources: _____**

**[VERIFY] Workplace, school/care, and route authorities: _____**

**[VERIFY] Insurance contact and relevant property-record office: _____**

**Verified by: _____ Date: _____ Next review: _____**

## TURN RESEARCH INTO ACTION

- ☐ Compare hazards across home, work, school/care, and routes; identify alternatives where one event could affect several places.
- ☐ Save official sources on phones and on paper. Keep a battery-radio or other backup method appropriate to local guidance.
- ☐ Write zone names and triggers into the household plan; do not preselect a route that officials may close.
- ☐ Discuss assistance, transport, medicines, power, communication, and animal needs before an alert.
- ☐ Review after a move, school/job/route change, insurance renewal, map revision, major incident, or official guidance update—and at least annually.

# Know Your Local Hazards — continued

## BINDER FOLLOW-THROUGH

**Section 7 — Hazard Guides:** use the guide for each hazard you identify to learn protective actions and hazard-specific supplies. Confirm every locally controlled trigger, zone, and instruction with its issuing authority.

**Section 8 — Plans & Records:** transfer verified alerts, contacts, meeting places, evacuation/shelter decisions, access needs, insurance information, inventories, and review dates into the household plan and protected records.

**SOURCES**

General preparedness and alerting: Ready.gov, “Be Informed” and “Alerts and Warnings”; FEMA, “Integrated Public Alert & Warning System for the American People”; and USA.gov, “State Emergency Management Agencies.” Mapping: FEMA, “Flood Maps”; U.S. Geological Survey, “Earthquake Hazards Program”; and U.S. Department of Agriculture Forest Service, “Wildfire Risk to Communities.” Records: National Association of Insurance Commissioners, “Disaster Preparedness.” All accessed September 25, 2026. Local instructions must be supplied and verified by the responsible local authority.